

TIP**SHARE RESULTS**

Ensure that the results of procedures such as prototype testing and market research are shared across all teams involved in a project, so that everyone is aware of potential problems.

Applying necessary expertise

Taking ideas through from conception to successful implementation involves bringing together multiple knowledge sets through a series of phases staged over time. It is important to ensure that all necessary skill sets are involved in the process along the way. One way of doing this is to run it as a simple sequential process, with responsibility for the project moving to different functional groups in the organization as it progresses. For example, in developing a physical product, the sequence might be:

- Marketing team initiates a new product concept.
- R&D team studies feasibility and demand.
- Small-scale production team develops and tests a prototype.
- Production department begins full-scale manufacture.
- Sales and marketing begin to promote the product that is ready for launch.

This model works a little like a relay race, with one group passing the baton on to the next, and may be suitable for projects where time is not a factor, and the success of the project is uncertain in the initial stages.



ASK YOURSELF... HOW WELL DOES YOUR ORGANIZATION MANAGE IMPLEMENTATION?

- Do we have clear and well-understood formal processes in place, to help us manage new product development effectively from idea to launch?
- Are our innovation projects usually completed on time and within budget?
- Do we have effective mechanisms for managing process change, from idea through to successful implementation?
- Do we have mechanisms in place to ensure early involvement of all departments in developing new products and processes?
- Is there sufficient flexibility in our system for product development to allow small "fast track" projects to happen?
- Do our innovation teams involve people from all relevant divisions?